Finding the Sweet Spot

Four promising new EP releases by independent artists show that relationships remain an endless source of inspiration



ANTHONY KARBHARI

Singer/ songwriters seem to be everywhere right now, and though most tend to release singles rather than albums, a handful have found a comfort zone in the middle ground that is the EP: collections of three to six tracks that allow them to express their ideas more completely. Here are four recent releases by a mix of established and upcoming stars.

Frizzell D'Souza
In My Asymmetry



Frizzell D'Souza's sophomore EP adds bubbling synths and orchestral soundscapes to the kind of acoustic guitar-driven tunes that featured on her 2022 debut, the well-received *The Hills Know Of You*. Blessed with one of the best voices to emerge out of the Indian indie scene in recent times, she charms again with songs variously dedicated to lovers, family and friends, each of which matches her technical dexterity with raw vulnerability.



PRARTHANA SHETTY

Kamakshi Khanna
Heartbreak 2020





She's equally adept at writing and singing in Hindi, but Kamakshi Khanna's new English EP will hit home with anyone who's been in a situationship, irrespective of the language in which they prefer listening to her music. Composed in her bedroom during the pandemic-induced lockdown, she first shared them online as the *Green Room Sessions*. The tracks and their subject matter—awkward encounters with crushes, feeling like you're constantly being played, experiencing anxiety at not being in a relationship—ring as true four years on as they did back then.



Neel Adhikari
Four Little Things We Did



A popular web series composer, Neel Adhikari has contributed to the soundtracks of *Laakhon Mein Ek* (2017) and *Tooth Pari* (2023) to name only two. His songs for *Little Things* (2016) kicked things off, and this EP